



HISTORY WILL NOT FORGIVE US IF WE DO NOT ASSUME POWER NOW

THE OCTOBER REVOLUTION (1917)

IN CONTEXT

FOCUS

Russian Revolution

BEFORE

1898 The Russian Socialist Democratic Labor Party is formed.

1905 Russia suffers a crushing defeat in a war against Japan, which leads to an uprising.

1914 Russia enters World War I and quickly suffers heavy losses in defeats to Germany on the Eastern Front.

AFTER

1918 Czar Nicholas II and his family are executed.

1922 Lenin creates the Union of Soviet Socialist Republics (USSR) under the control of the Communist Party.

1929 Stalin becomes leader of the USSR and establishes a dictatorship.

In October 1917, Russia was in turmoil after suffering huge losses in World War I. There were food shortages, and workers in the cities faced low wages and appalling conditions. The February Revolution had ousted the Czar, but the Provisional Government that replaced him faced imminent collapse.

Vladimir Lenin, a member of the revolutionary Bolshevik Party, took full advantage. He was committed to

The **Russian Revolution** of 1905 forces a **range of reforms** from the autocratic Czar Nicholas II.



Dissatisfaction persists among the people.



Russia suffers defeats in World War I.



Economic hardship leads to **food riots**.



In February 1917, the **monarchy is overthrown** and replaced by the Provisional Government. **The Czar abdicates** in March.



Lenin and the Bolsheviks demand total power for the proletariat, launching the October Revolution.

a workers' (proletarian) revolution and set out a series of proposals to overthrow the government in what became known as his April Theses. His simple slogan "Peace, land, and bread!" became a revolutionary rallying cry. On October 24 (November 6, Gregorian calendar [GC]), there were attempts by the government to curb the